

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12401735
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Yan; Bin et al.

Electronic device

Abstract

An electronic device includes a middle frame, a first flexible printed circuit FPC, a second FPC and a battery. Projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a first overlapping region. The first overlapping region is located inside a projection of the battery on the middle frame and is far away from an edge of the battery. A first through hole is disposed on the middle frame. The first overlapping region is located in the first through hole. The electronic device provided in this application can implement reduction of an overall thickness, so that the electronic device provides better user experience.

Inventors:	Yan; Bin (Shenzhen, CN), Xue; Kangle (Shenzhen, CN), Liu; Xiulan (Shenzhen, CN), Gao; Jiuliang (Shenzhen, CN)
Applicant:	HONOR DEVICE CO., LTD. (Shenzhen, CN)
Family ID:	1000008777397
Assignee:	Honor Device Co., Ltd. (Shenzhen, CN)
Appl. No.:	17/794218
Filed (or PCT Filed):	August 30, 2021
PCT No.:	PCT/CN2021/115288
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2022/068497
PCT Pub. Date:	April 07, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230224394 A1	Jul. 13, 2023

Foreign Application Priority Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **H05K1/14** (20060101); **H04M1/02** (20060101); **H05K1/11** (20060101); **H05K1/18** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04M1/0277** (20130101); **H04M1/0262** (20130101); **H05K1/115** (20130101); **H05K1/147** (20130101); **H05K1/189** (20130101); H05K2201/10037 (20130101); H05K2201/10128 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H05K (1/189); H05K (1/147); H05K (1/115); H05K (1/028); H05K (2201/10037); H05K (2201/10128); H04M (1/0277); H04M (1/0262); G06F (1/1652)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2009/0186661	12/2008	Kim	455/566	H05K 1/147
2020/0042125	12/2019	Lee	N/A	H05K 1/189
2022/0155826	12/2021	An et al.	N/A	N/A
2023/0224396	12/2022	Park	361/679.01	H05K 1/189

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
108600425	12/2017	CN	N/A
109618030	12/2018	CN	N/A
214045690	12/2020	CN	N/A
2293528	12/2010	EP	N/A
2876868	12/2014	EP	N/A
2020171447	12/2019	WO	N/A

Primary Examiner: Varghese; Roshn K

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Fish & Richardson P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a National Stage of International Application No. PCT/CN2021/115288, filed on Aug. 30, 2021, which claims priority to Chinese Patent Application No. 202022217809.3, filed on Sep. 30, 2020. The disclosures of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) This application relates to the field of electronic product technologies, and in particular, to an electronic device.

BACKGROUND

(3) With development of science and technology, consumer electronic products such as smartphones and tablet computers are popularized rapidly. This greatly promotes development of the society and facilitates people's life. To achieve an exquisite appearance and perfect user experience, an increasingly high requirement is posed on mobile phone design. How to make a mobile phone lighter and thinner becomes a major challenge to structure design.

(4) In a current design solution, to reduce an overall thickness of a mobile phone, a three-section design architecture is usually used. A main board is disposed at an upper end of a battery, a sub-board is disposed at a lower end of the battery, and a main flexible printed circuit (flexible printed circuit, FPC) is used to connect the main board and the sub-board. In addition, as a standard component of the mobile phone, a display is usually connected to the main board through a built-in screen FPC. To make full use of internal space of the mobile phone, the main FPC is usually disposed between the battery and a middle frame, and the screen FPC is usually disposed between the display and the middle frame. Herein, the middle frame refers to a mechanical part between the screen and the battery, and may alternatively be a front cover in some solutions in the industry.

(5) In this case, both the main FPC and the screen FPC are disposed in a thickness direction of the mobile phone. This inevitably increases the overall thickness of the mobile phone. The two FPCs and the middle frame overlap between the battery and the screen, and this becomes a thickness bottleneck of the entire mobile phone. In addition, an overlapping position is close to a battery edge. In consideration of battery safety, a hole design on the middle frame at the battery edge is not allowed. Moreover, due to a processing limit, a thickness of the middle frame cannot be further reduced. This is not conducive to lighting and thinning of the mobile phone.

SUMMARY

(6) A technical problem to be resolved in embodiments of this application is to provide an electronic device with a relatively small overall thickness.

(7) According to a first aspect, an electronic device is provided, including a middle frame, a first flexible printed circuit FPC, a second FPC, and a battery. Projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a first overlapping region, the first overlapping region is located inside a projection of the battery on the middle frame and is far away from an edge of the battery, a first through hole is disposed on the middle frame, and the first overlapping region is located in the first through hole.

(8) According to the electronic device provided in embodiments of this application, the first through hole is disposed on the middle frame, a position of the first through hole is corresponding to the overlapping region between the first FPC and the second FPC, and a projection of the overlapping region is completely located in the first through hole, so that a thickness of the overlapping region includes thicknesses of only the first FPC and the second FPC (for example, the FPC's can be flexibly deformed, and the two FPCs may be put close to the first through hole). In other words, a hole is punched on the middle frame at the overlapping region of the two FPCs, so that only two components overlap in the overlapping region. In addition, only two components (the first FPC and the middle frame, or the second FPC and the middle frame) overlap at any other position in the projection of the battery. Compared with that in a conventional solution (a sum of thicknesses of two FPCs and a middle frame constitutes a bottleneck of an overall thickness), the electronic device provided in embodiments of this application has one less component in the thickness direction, which helps reduce the overall thickness of the electronic device (the overall thickness may be reduced by 0.1 millimeter to 0.2 millimeter or more). In this way, the overall thickness can be reduced, so that the electronic device provides better user experience.

(9) Further, the overlapping region between the two FPCs of the electronic device provided in

embodiments of this application is located inside the projection of the battery on the middle frame, and is far away from the edge of the battery, so that the position of the first through hole can be far away from the edge of the battery. In this way, the middle frame can better support and protect the battery. Because a burr that may be generated when a hole is punched on the middle frame does not damage the relatively fragile edge position of the battery, use safety performance of the battery can be ensured. This helps improve overall performance of the electronic device.

(10) It should be understood that, in embodiments of this application, the first through hole is larger than the overlapping region, so that the projection of the overlapping region can be completely located in the first through hole. However, the first through hole should not be excessively large, to avoid affecting support performance of the middle frame. In addition, the first through hole should be away from the edge of the battery as far as possible, to ensure use safety performance of the battery.

(11) Herein, an overlapping region (that is, the foregoing first overlapping region) is inside the projection of the battery on the middle frame, and is far away from the edge of the battery. That the overlapping region is far away from the edge of the battery may mean that the overlapping region is not close to the edge of the battery, and a disposing position of the first through hole that is determined based on the overlapping region is not close to the edge of the battery, so that no adverse effect is caused on the edge of the battery (for example, an internal electrode).

(12) Optionally, the first through hole and the first overlapping region have a same shape and a same size. In this case, contours of the first through hole and the first overlapping region completely overlap.

(13) For example, both the first through hole and the first overlapping region are rectangular.

(14) Optionally, the first through hole is larger than the first overlapping region, and the first overlapping region is completely located in the first through hole. In this case, a shape of the first through hole and a shape of the first overlapping region may be the same or different. This is not limited in this application.

(15) For example, both the first through hole and the first overlapping region are rectangular, and the first through hole is larger than the first overlapping region.

(16) For another example, the first overlapping region is rectangular, a shape of the first through hole is any one of a circle, an oval, a trapezoid, a rhombus, an irregular shape, or the like, an area of the first through hole is larger than that of the first overlapping region, and the first overlapping region is completely located in the first through hole.

(17) Optionally, the first FPC and the second FPC may be located on two opposite sides of the middle frame.

(18) Optionally, the first FPC and the second FPC may alternatively be located on a same side of the middle frame, for example, both are located between the middle frame and the display, or both are located between the middle frame and the battery. This is not limited in this application. In a possible design, an avoidance hole is disposed on the first FPC, and the first FPC avoids the second FPC by using the avoidance hole, so that the first overlapping region is far away from the edge of the battery.

(19) A main purpose of the avoidance hole is to avoid the second FPC within a specific range from the edge of the battery. To implement an avoidance effect, the projection of the avoidance hole on the middle frame should completely cover a projection of the second FPC on the opposite side. In this case, a width of the avoidance hole should be greater than or equal to a width of the second FPC.

(20) Optionally, the first FPC may be in any shape, such as a rectangle, a rhombus, a trapezoid, a circle, or any irregular shape. This is not limited in this application.

(21) In a possible design, the middle frame includes a protrusion part, a front end of the protrusion part extends into the avoidance hole, and a rear end of the protrusion part forms avoidance space accommodating the second FPC.

- (22) Optionally, the front end of the protrusion part may be embedded in the avoidance hole. Alternatively, the front end of the protrusion part is disposed near (close to) the avoidance hole.
- (23) In embodiments of this application, the protrusion part and the avoidance space are disposed, so that a region in the avoidance hole also has a thickness of only two components (the middle frame and the second FPC), which helps reduce the overall thickness of the electronic device. In this way, the overall thickness can be reduced, so that the electronic device provides better user experience.
- (24) In a possible design, the projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a second overlapping region, the first FPC further includes a thinning region, a thickness of the thinning region is less than a thickness of another region of the first FPC, and a projection of the thinning region on the middle frame covers the second overlapping region.
- (25) In a possible design, the first overlapping region is connected to the second overlapping region.
- (26) In a possible design, the first FPC includes an FPC body and a functional film layer that are stacked, and thinning is performed on the FPC body and/or the functional film layer to form the thinning region.
- (27) In a possible design, the functional film layer includes a protective film layer and a shielding film layer.
- (28) In a possible design, a first groove and a second groove are respectively disposed on two side surfaces of the middle frame, the first FPC is disposed in the first groove, and the second FPC is disposed in the second groove.
- (29) In a possible design, the first FPC is a screen FPC of the electronic device, and the second FPC is a main FPC of the electronic device.
- (30) Optionally, the first FPC is electrically connected to the display and the main board through welding, and the second FPC is electrically connected to the main board and the sub-board through welding.
- (31) Optionally, the first FPC is electrically connected to the display and the main board through a connector, and the second FPC is electrically connected to the main board and the sub-board through a connector.
- (32) For example, the connector may be a zero insertion force connector or a board to board connector.
- (33) In a possible design, the first FPC is fixedly attached to an inner surface of a display of the electronic device by using a first back adhesive layer, and the second FPC is fixedly attached to the middle frame by using a second back adhesive layer.
- (34) In a possible design, a third groove is further disposed on the middle frame in the second groove, and the second back adhesive layer is disposed in the third groove.
- (35) In a possible design, the first FPC passes through a second through hole disposed on the middle frame and is electrically connected to a main board of the electronic device.
-

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of a smartphone from a perspective in the conventional technology;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of a smartphone from another perspective in the conventional technology;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of an electronic device according to an embodiment of this application;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a schematic connection diagram of a partial inner structure of an electronic device

according to an embodiment of this application;

(5) FIG. 5 is an exploded view of an electronic device from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application;

(6) FIG. 6 is an exploded view of an electronic device from another perspective according to an embodiment of this application;

(7) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of a structure of a main board according to an embodiment of this application;

(8) FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a structure of a display from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application;

(9) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a partial inner structure of an electronic device according to an embodiment of this application;

(10) FIG. 10 is a sectional view in a direction A-A in FIG. 9;

(11) FIG. 11 is a sectional view in a direction B-B in FIG. 9;

(12) FIG. 12 is a sectional view in a direction C-C in FIG. 9;

(13) FIG. 13 is a schematic connection diagram of another example of a partial inner structure of an electronic device according to an embodiment of this application;

(14) FIG. 14 is a sectional view in a direction D-D in FIG. 13;

(15) FIG. 15 is a schematic diagram of a structure of an example of the first FPC in FIG. 13;

(16) FIG. 16 is a schematic diagram of a structure of another example of the first FPC in FIG. 13;

(17) FIG. 17 is an exploded view of another example of an electronic device from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application; and

(18) FIG. 18 is an exploded view of another example of an electronic device from another perspective according to an embodiment of this application.

(19) Reference numerals: 1. main board; 2. sub-board; 3. middle frame; 4. battery; 5. main FPC; 6. screen FPC; 7. perforation; 8. display: S, overlapping region; 10. housing; 20. display; 30. middle frame; 31. first through hole; 32. second through hole; 33. first groove; 34. second groove; 35. third groove; 36. middle-frame battery compartment; 37. protrusion part; 38, avoidance space; 40. first FPC; 40a. FPC body; 40b. functional film layer; 41 avoidance hole; 42. first back adhesive layer; 43. thinning region; 50. second FPC; 51. second back adhesive layer; 52. bending part; 60. battery; 61. third back adhesive layer; 70. main board; 80. sub-board; 90. bezel; 100. electronic device; s1. first overlapping region; s2. second overlapping region.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(20) The following describes in detail implementations of this application, examples of the implementations are shown in the accompanying drawings, and identical or similar reference numerals represent identical or similar elements or elements having identical or similar functions. The following implementations described with reference to the accompanying drawings are examples, and are merely intended to explain this application, but should not be construed as a limitation on this application.

(21) In the descriptions of this application, it should be understood that the terms “first”, “second”, and “third” are merely used for description, but should not be understood as indicating or implying relative importance or implying a quantity of indicated technical features. Therefore, a feature limited by “first”, “second”, or “third” may explicitly or implicitly include one or more features. In the descriptions of this application. “a plurality of” means two or more, unless otherwise specifically limited.

(22) In the descriptions of this application, it should be noted that, unless otherwise specified and limited, the terms “mount” and “connect” should be understood in a broad sense, for example, may indicate a fixed connection, a detachable connection, an integral connection, a mechanical connection, an electrical connection, mutual communication, a direct connection, an indirect connection through an intermediate medium, an internal connection between two elements, or an interaction relationship between two elements. A person of ordinary skill in the art may understand

a specific meaning of the foregoing term in this application according to a specific situation.

(23) In the descriptions of this application, it should be understood that an orientation relationship or a position relationship indicated by terms “top”, “bottom”, “side”, “front”, and “rear” are an orientation relationship or a position relationship based on mounting, and is merely for ease of description and simplification of this application, but is not intended to indicate or imply that a specified apparatus or element necessarily has a specific orientation or is constructed and operated in a specific orientation. Therefore, the terms should not be construed as a limitation on this application.

(24) In the descriptions of this application, it should be noted that the term “and/or” is merely an association relationship for describing associated objects, and indicates that three relationships may exist. For example, A and/or B may indicate the following three cases: Only A exists, both A and B exist, and only B exists.

(25) It should be further noted that in embodiments of this application, a same reference numeral indicates a same part or a same component. For a same component or part in embodiments of this application, only one component or part may be marked with a reference numeral in the figure as an example. It should be understood that, for another same component or part, the reference numeral is also applicable.

(26) With development of science and technology, consumer electronic products such as smartphones and tablet computers are popularized rapidly. This greatly promotes development of the society and facilitates people's life. To achieve an exquisite appearance and perfect user experience, an increasingly high requirement is posed on mobile phone design. How to make a mobile phone lighter and thinner becomes a major challenge to structure design.

(27) A flexible printed circuit (flexible printed circuit, FPC) is a printed circuit board made of a flexible insulation material. The flexible printed circuit has many advantages that a rigid printed circuit board (printed circuit board, PCB) does not have. For example, the FPC may be bent, wound, or folded freely, and may be arranged based on a space layout requirement, to implement integration of component assembly and wire connection. Because of the foregoing advantages, using the FPC can effectively reduce a volume or a thickness of an electronic product, and improve circuit arrangement flexibility, to meet high density, miniaturization, and high reliability requirements on the electronic product.

(28) In a current design solution, to reduce an overall thickness of a mobile phone, a three-section design architecture is usually used, that is, a mechanical design of main board+battery+sub-board. The main board and the sub-board are electrically connected through an FPC. FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of a smartphone from a perspective in the conventional technology. FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of a smartphone from another perspective in the conventional technology.

(29) As shown in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, a middle frame 3 and a battery 4 are successively disposed between a display 8 and a rear cover (not shown in the figures) of the smartphone. A main board 1, a sub-board 2, and the battery 4 are disposed in parallel, the main board 1 is disposed at an upper end of the battery 4, the sub-board 2 is disposed at a lower end of the battery 4, and the main board 1 and the sub-board 2 are electrically connected through a main FPC 5. The display is electrically connected to the main board 1 through a built-in screen FPC 6. To make full use of internal space of the smartphone, the main FPC 5 is disposed between the battery 4 and the middle frame 3, and the screen FPC 6 is disposed between the display 8 and the middle frame 3. In other words, the main FPC 5 and the screen FPC 6 are respectively disposed on two opposite sides of the middle frame 3.

(30) Further, as shown in FIG. 1, the screen FPC 6 is located on a front side of the middle frame 3, the main board 1, the sub-board 2, the battery 4, and the main FPC 5 are located on a rear side of the middle frame 3, and the main FPC 5 passes between the middle frame 3 and the battery 4 to connect the main board 1 and the sub-board 2. Because the screen FPC 6 and the main board 1 are

located on two opposite sides of the middle frame **3**, to implement connection between the screen FPC **6** and the main board **1**, a perforation **7** may be disposed on the middle frame **3**. One end of the screen FPC **6** is electrically connected to the display **8**, and the other end of the screen FPC **6** passes through the perforation **7**, and is electrically connected to the main board **1** on the rear side of the middle frame **3**.

(31) Because both the main FPC **5** and the screen FPC **6** are disposed in a thickness direction of the smartphone, an overall thickness of the mobile phone inevitably increases. As shown in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**, the two FPCs and the middle frame **3** have an overlapping region **S** between the battery **4** and the display **8**, and a thickness of the overlapping region **S** is a sum of thicknesses of the two FPCs and the middle frame **3**. Existence of the overlapping region **S** becomes a design bottleneck of the overall thickness.

(32) The overlapping region **S** is close to an edge of the battery **4**. A plurality of electrodes are disposed inside the edge of the battery **4**. If a hole is punched on the middle frame **3**, a burr is likely to appear on the middle frame **3**. The burr is likely to puncture the battery **4**, causing a short circuit between the electrodes inside the battery **4**, and affecting safety performance of the battery **4**.

(33) In other words, in consideration of safety of the battery **4**, punching is usually not allowed on the middle frame **3** at the edge of the battery **4**. In addition, a thickness of the middle frame **3** has a processing limit (for example, in a current processing technology, a limit thickness of the middle frame is 0.35 mm), and further thinning cannot be achieved. This impedes lighting and thinning design of the smartphone, and is not conducive to lighting and thinning development of the smartphone.

(34) In conclusion, in embodiments of this application, an inner structure of an electronic device is improved, to provide an electronic device with a relatively small overall thickness, so as to improve user experience.

(35) An embodiment of this application provides an electronic device. The electronic device may be a device such as a mobile phone (for example, a common mobile phone or a foldable mobile phone), a tablet computer, a notebook computer, or a wearable device, but is not limited thereto.

(36) FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram of an overall structure of an electronic device **100** according to an embodiment of this application. By way of example and not limitation, in this embodiment of this application, the electronic device **100** is a mobile phone, and includes a housing **10** and a display **20**. The display **20** is mounted on the housing **10**. The electronic device **100** further includes electronic components (not shown in the figure) disposed inside the housing **10**. The electronic components include but are not limited to a circuit board, a processor, a camera, a flash, a microphone, a battery, and the like.

(37) The housing **10** may be a metal housing, for example, a metal such as a magnesium alloy or a stainless steel. Alternatively, the housing **10** may be a plastic housing, a glass housing, a ceramic housing, or the like, but is not limited thereto. The housing **10** includes structures such as a bezel and a rear cover.

(38) As a front panel of the electronic device **100**, the display **20** forms accommodation space with the housing **10**. The accommodation space is used to accommodate an electronic component or a function component of the electronic device **100**. The display **20** forms a display surface of the electronic device **100**, and is configured to display information such as an image and a text. The display **20** may be a light-emitting diode (light-emitting diode. LED) display, a liquid crystal display (liquid crystal display, LCD), an organic light-emitting diode (organic light-emitting diode. OLED) display, or the like, but is not limited thereto. In addition, the display **20** may be a foldable display (flexible display).

(39) FIG. **4** is a schematic connection diagram of a partial inner structure of the electronic device **100** according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. **5** is an exploded view of the electronic device **100** from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. **6** is an exploded view of the electronic device **100** from another perspective according to an embodiment

of this application. FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of a structure of a main board 70 according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. 8 is a schematic diagram of a structure of the display 20 from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application.

(40) As shown in FIG. 4 to FIG. 8, the electronic device 100 provided in embodiments of this application includes a middle frame 30, a first flexible printed circuit FPC 40, a second FPC 50, and a battery 60. The first FPC 40 and the second FPC 50 are respectively disposed on two opposite sides of the middle frame 30.

(41) Projections of the first FPC 40 and the second FPC 50 on the middle frame 30 have a first overlapping region s1, and the first overlapping region s1 is located inside a projection of the battery 60 on the middle frame 30 and is away from an edge of the battery 60.

(42) A first through hole 31 is disposed on the middle frame 30, and the first overlapping region s1 is located in the first through hole 31.

(43) A flexible printed circuit (flexible printed circuit, FPC) is briefly referred to as a flexible board, and is also referred to as a “flexible line board” or “flexible circuit board”. The flexible printed circuit is a highly reliable and optimal flexible printed circuit board made by using polyimide or polyester film as a material.

(44) In this application, the flexible printed circuit also includes a flexible-rigid structure board. In this case, a partial region may be a rigid circuit board.

(45) In embodiments of this application, the middle frame 30 is disposed inside the electronic device 100. The middle frame 30 divides inner accommodation space of the electronic device 100 into two parts: accommodation space between the display 20 and the middle frame 30 and accommodation space between the middle frame 30 and the rear cover. The first FPC 40 is disposed in the accommodation space between the display 20 and the middle frame 30, and the second FPC 50 is disposed in the accommodation space between the middle frame 30 and the rear cover, that is, the first FPC 40 and the second FPC 50 are respectively disposed on two opposite sides of the middle frame 30.

(46) Further, the electronic device 100 includes the battery 60. The battery 60 is disposed in the accommodation space between the middle frame 30 and the rear cover, and the second FPC 50 is located between the middle frame 30 and the battery 60.

(47) As shown in FIG. 4, the first FPC 40 and the second FPC 50 have an overlapping (or intersection) region. More specifically, the projections of the first FPC 40 and the second FPC 50 on the middle frame 30 have the first overlapping region s1, and the first overlapping region s1 is located inside the projection of the battery 60 on the middle frame 30 and is away from the edge of the battery 60.

(48) As shown in FIG. 4 to FIG. 7, in embodiments of this application, the first through hole 31 is disposed on the middle frame 30, the first through hole 31 penetrates two sides of the middle frame 30, and the first overlapping region s1 is located in the first through hole 31. To be specific, a shape and a size of the first through hole 31 match those of the first overlapping region s1.

(49) Optionally, the first through hole 31 and the first overlapping region s1 have a same shape and a same size. In this case, contours of the first through hole 31 and the first overlapping region s1 completely overlap.

(50) As shown in FIG. 4 to FIG. 7, in embodiments of this application, both the first through hole 31 and the first overlapping region s1 are rectangular.

(51) Optionally, the first through hole 31 is larger than the first overlapping region s1, and the first overlapping region s1 is completely located in the first through hole 31. In this case, a shape of the first through hole 31 and a shape of the first overlapping region s1 may be the same or different. This is not limited in this application.

(52) For example, both the first through hole 31 and the first overlapping region s1 are rectangular, and the first through hole 31 is larger than the first overlapping region s1.

(53) For another example, the first overlapping region s1 is rectangular, a shape of the first through

hole **31** is any one of a circle, an oval, a trapezoid, a rhombus, an irregular shape, or the like, an area of the first through hole **31** is larger than that of the first overlapping region **s1**, and the first overlapping region **s1** is completely located in the first through hole **31**.

(54) According to the electronic device **100** provided in embodiments of this application, the first through hole **31** is disposed on the middle frame **30**, a position of the first through hole **31** is corresponding to the overlapping region between the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50**, and the projection of the overlapping region is completely located in the first through hole **31**, so that a thickness of the overlapping region includes only thicknesses of the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** (for example, the FPCs can be flexibly deformed, and the two FPCs may be put close to the first through hole **31**). In other words, a hole is punched on the middle frame **30** at the overlapping region of the two FPCs, so that only two components overlap in the overlapping region. In addition, only two components (the first FPC **40** and the middle frame **30**, or the second FPC **50** and the middle frame **30**) overlap at any other position in the projection of the battery **60**.

Compared with that in a conventional solution (a sum of thicknesses of two FPCs and a middle frame constitutes a bottleneck of an overall thickness), the electronic device **100** provided in embodiments of this application has one less component in the thickness direction, which helps reduce the overall thickness of the electronic device **100** (the overall thickness may be reduced by 0.1 millimeter to 0.2 millimeter or more). In this way, the overall thickness can be reduced, so that the electronic device **100** provides better user experience.

(55) Further, the overlapping region between the two FPCs of the electronic device **100** provided in embodiments of this application is located inside the projection of the battery **60** on the middle frame **30**, and is far away from the edge of the battery **60**, so that the position of the first through hole **31** can be far away from the edge of the battery **60**. In this way, the middle frame **30** can better support and protect the battery **60**. Because a burr that may be generated when a hole is punched on the middle frame **30** does not damage the relatively fragile edge position of the battery **60**, use safety performance of the battery **60** can be ensured. This helps improve overall performance of the electronic device **100**.

(56) It should be understood that, in embodiments of this application, the first through hole **31** is larger than the overlapping region, so that the projection of the overlapping region can be completely located in the first through hole. However, the first through hole **31** should not be excessively large, to avoid affecting support performance of the middle frame **30**. In addition, the first through hole **31** should be away from the edge of the battery **60** as far as possible, to ensure use safety performance of the battery **60**.

(57) It should be noted that the electronic device **100** provided in embodiments of this application is not limited to the foregoing three-section architecture design, and another architecture design may also be applicable.

(58) In embodiments of this application, the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** are respectively disposed on two opposite sides of the middle frame **30**. In another implementation, the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** may alternatively be located on a same side of the middle frame **30**, for example, both are located between the middle frame **30** and the display **20**, or both are located between the middle frame **30** and the battery **60**. This is not limited in this application.

(59) Herein, an overlapping region (that is, the foregoing first overlapping region **s1**) is inside the projection of the battery **60** on the middle frame **30**, and is far away from the edge of the battery **60**. That the overlapping region is far away from the edge of the battery **60** may mean that the overlapping region is not close to the edge of the battery **60**, and a disposing position of the first through hole **31** that is determined based on the overlapping region is not close to the edge of the battery **60**, so that no adverse effect is caused on the edge of the battery **60** (for example, an internal electrode).

(60) How to make the overlapping region between the first FPC and the second FPC inside the battery **60** and away from the edge of the battery **60** is not limited in embodiments of this

application. Positions (for example, orientations) for disposing the first FPC and the second FPC may be arbitrarily arranged according to a specific requirement, to achieve the foregoing objective. This is not limited in this application.

(61) In embodiments of this application, a hole is added to the first FPC to avoid overlapping of the two FPCs at the edge of the battery **60**, and an overlapping position (that is, the foregoing first overlapping region **s1**) is transferred to the inside of the projection of the battery **60** and is far away from the edge of the battery **60**.

(62) Specifically, as shown in FIG. **4** to FIG. **8**, in embodiments of this application, an avoidance hole **41** is disposed on the first FPC **40**, the avoidance hole **41** is a through hole, and the first FPC **40** avoids the second FPC **50** by using the avoidance hole **41**, so that the first overlapping region **s1** is far away from the edge of the battery **60**.

(63) In this case, a projection of the avoidance hole **41** on the middle frame **30** is connected to the projection of the first overlapping region **s1**, and after passing through the avoidance hole **41**, the second FPC **50** overlaps the first FPC **40** to form the first overlapping region **s1**.

(64) A main purpose of the avoidance hole **41** is to avoid the second FPC **50** within a specific range from the edge of the battery **60**. To implement an avoidance effect, the projection of the avoidance hole **41** on the middle frame **30** should completely cover a projection of the second FPC **50** on the opposite side. In this case, a width of the avoidance hole **41** should be greater than or equal to a width of the second FPC **50**.

(65) Optionally, the first FPC **40** may be in any shape, such as a rectangle, a rhombus, a trapezoid, a circle, or any irregular shape. This is not limited in this application.

(66) In embodiments of this application, the first FPC **40** is a screen FPC of the electronic device **100**, and the second FPC **50** is a main FPC of the electronic device **100**.

(67) Specifically, as shown in FIG. **4** to FIG. **8**, the electronic device **100** further includes a main board **70** and a sub-board **80**. The first FPC **40** may be a screen FPC. In this case, one end of the first FPC **40** is electrically connected to the display **20** (the first FPC **40** may be considered as a part of a display module), and the other end of the first FPC **40** is electrically connected to the main board **70** after passing through a second through hole **32** disposed on the middle frame **30**.

(68) The second FPC **50** may be a main FPC of the electronic device **100**. In this case, one end of the second FPC **50** is electrically connected to the main board **70**, and the other end of the second FPC **50** is electrically connected to the sub-board **80**. In this case, the second FPC **50** may be located between the middle frame **30** and the battery **60**.

(69) Optionally, the first FPC **40** is electrically connected to the display **20** and the main board **70** through welding, and the second FPC **50** is electrically connected to the main board **70** and the sub-board **80** through welding.

(70) Optionally, the first FPC **40** is electrically connected to the display **20** and the main board **70** through a connector, and the second FPC **50** is electrically connected to the main board **70** and the sub-board **80** through a connector.

(71) For example, the connector may be a zero insertion force (zero insertion force, ZIF) connector or a board to board (board to board, BTB) connector.

(72) Optionally, the first FPC **40** may be a conventional FPC, or may be a special flexible board such as a chip on film (chip on flex or chip on film, COF) or a chip on plastic (chip on plastic, COP). This is not limited in this application.

(73) Optionally, a main circuit, a chip, a sensor, an interface, a plug-in, and the like of the electronic device **100** may be disposed on the main board **70**, and a USB interface, an antenna contact, a radio frequency interface, and the like of the electronic device **100** may be disposed on the sub-board **80**.

(74) Optionally, in another implementation, the first FPC **40** may be an FPC that implements an electrical connection to another component and that is other than the screen FPC and the main FPC, and the second FPC **50** may be an FPC that implements an electrical connection to another

component and that is other than the screen FPC and the main FPC. This is not limited in this application.

(75) Optionally, the battery **60** may be a lithium battery or a nickel-cadmium battery. This is not limited in this application.

(76) As shown in FIG. 5 to FIG. 7, the electronic device **100** further includes a bezel **90**. The bezel **90** is disposed around an outer circumference of the middle frame **30** and is fixedly connected to the middle frame **30**. The bezel **90** and the middle frame **30** may be integrally molded.

(77) As shown in FIG. 5 to FIG. 7, a first groove **33** and a second groove **34** are respectively disposed on two side surfaces of the middle frame **30**, the first FPC **40** is disposed in the first groove **33**, and the second FPC **50** is disposed in the second groove **34**.

(78) Specifically, the first groove **33** and the second groove **34** may be respectively disposed on the two side surfaces of the middle frame **30**, a shape of the first groove **33** is consistent with a shape of the first FPC **40**, and the first FPC **40** is correspondingly embedded in the first groove **33**.

(79) Optionally, a depth of the first groove **33** matches a height of the first FPC **40**. For example, the depth of the first groove **33** may be greater than, less than, or equal to the height of the first FPC **40**.

(80) Further, the second through hole **32** is disposed at an end of the first groove **33**, and an end of the first FPC **40** passes through the second through hole **32** and is electrically connected to the main board **70** on the other side of the middle frame **30**.

(81) A shape of the second groove **34** is consistent with a shape of the second FPC **50**, and the second FPC **50** is correspondingly embedded in the second groove **34**.

(82) Optionally, a depth of the second groove **34** matches a height of the second FPC **50**. For example, the depth of the second groove **34** may be greater than, less than, or equal to the height of the second FPC **50**.

(83) In embodiments of this application, the groove is disposed on the middle frame **30** to accommodate the FPC, so that the FPC can be better positioned and fastened, and this helps further reduce the thickness of the electronic device **100**.

(84) FIG. 9 is a perspective view of a partial inner structure of the electronic device **100** according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. 10 is a sectional view in a direction A-A in FIG. 9. FIG. 11 is a sectional view in a direction B-B in FIG. 9. FIG. 12 is a sectional view in a direction C-C in FIG. 9.

(85) As shown in FIG. 5 to FIG. 7. FIG. 9, and FIG. 12, in embodiments of this application, the middle frame **30** includes a protrusion part **37**, a front end of the protrusion part **37** is embedded in the avoidance hole **41**, and a rear end of the protrusion part **37** forms avoidance space **38** for accommodating the second FPC **50**.

(86) Specifically, a shape of the protrusion part **37** matches a shape and a size of the avoidance hole **41**, the protrusion part **37** is embedded in the avoidance hole **41**, and a front-end surface of the protrusion part **37** may be flush with a surface that is of the first FPC **40** and that is away from the middle frame **30**. The second FPC **50** is accommodated in the avoidance space **38** on the opposite side.

(87) In embodiments of this application, the protrusion part **37** and the avoidance space **38** are disposed, so that a region in the avoidance hole **41** also has a thickness of only two components (the middle frame **30** and the second FPC **50**), which helps reduce the overall thickness of the electronic device **100**. In this way, the overall thickness can be reduced, so that the electronic device **100** provides better user experience.

(88) Optionally, the front end of the protrusion part **37** may extend into the avoidance hole **41**, but is not embedded in the avoidance hole **41**. For example, the front end of the protrusion part **37** may be disposed near (close to) the avoidance hole. In this case, a thinning effect can also be achieved.

(89) In embodiments of this application, the middle frame **30** includes the protrusion part **37**. The protrusion part **37** protrudes outward relative to a bottom wall of the first groove **33**, and may or

may not protrude relative to another part of the middle frame **30**. To be specific, a height of a top end of the protrusion part **37** may be greater than, equal to, or less than a height of another part of the middle frame **30**. This is not limited in this application.

(90) As shown in FIG. 5 to FIG. 7 and FIG. 10 to FIG. 12, the first FPC **40** is fixedly attached to an inner surface of the display **20** of the electronic device **100** by using a first back adhesive layer **42**, and the second FPC **50** is fixedly attached to the middle frame **30** by using a second back adhesive layer **51**. The battery **60** may be fixedly attached to the middle frame **30** by using a third back adhesive layer **61**.

(91) Further, a third groove **35** is disposed on the middle frame **30** in the second groove **34**, and the second back adhesive layer **42** is disposed in the third groove **35**.

(92) Optionally, a plurality of second back adhesive layers **51** may be disposed, and correspondingly, a plurality of third grooves **35** are disposed. This is not limited in this application. For example, as shown in FIG. 5, three second back adhesive layers **51** and three third grooves **35** may be correspondingly disposed, and are separated from each other, so that the first FPC **40** can be reliably fastened.

(93) FIG. 13 is a schematic connection diagram of another example of a partial inner structure of the electronic device **100** according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. 14 is a sectional view in a direction D-D in FIG. 13.

(94) As shown in FIG. 13 and FIG. 14, the projections of the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** on the middle frame **30** have a second overlapping region **s2**, and the first FPC **40** further includes a thinning region **43**. A thickness of the thinning region **43** is less than a thickness of another region of the first FPC **40**, and a projection of the thinning region **43** on the middle frame **30** covers the second overlapping region **s2**.

(95) In the foregoing embodiment, the avoidance hole **41** is disposed on the first FPC **40**. In this embodiment, the first FPC **40** further includes the thinning region **43**. The thinning region **43** is corresponding to the foregoing avoidance hole **41**. The avoidance hole **41** in the foregoing embodiments is a through hole. Alternatively, the avoidance hole **41** may be a blind hole (that is, the first FPC **40** is not penetrated), to form the thinning region **43** in this embodiment. In other words, only a part of the first FPC **40** in a thickness direction is removed, and the first FPC **40** is not penetrated, to implement reduction by a specific thickness.

(96) A shape and a size of the thinning region **43** are similar to those of the foregoing avoidance hole **41**, and the projection of the thinning region **43** on the middle frame **30** covers the second overlapping region **s2**, that is, covers the second FPC **50** at a corresponding position.

(97) Further, the second overlapping region **s2** is connected to the first overlapping region **s1**. To be specific, in this case, the second overlapping region **s2** is disposed to transfer the first overlapping region **s1** to the inside of the projection of the battery **60** and make the first overlapping region **s1** far away from the edge of the battery **60**.

(98) FIG. 15 is a schematic diagram of a structure of an example of the first FPC **40** in FIG. 13.

(99) As shown in FIG. 15, the first FPC **40** includes an FPC body **40a** and a functional film layer **40b** that are stacked, and thinning may be performed on the FPC body **40a** and/or the functional film layer **40b** to form the thinning region **43**.

(100) How to form the thinning region **43** is not limited in this application. In this embodiment, thinning may be performed on the functional film layer **40b** to form the thinning region **43**. In this case, a part or all of at least one functional film layer **40b** covered by the FPC body **40a** may be removed, to form the thinning region **43**.

(101) Optionally, the functional film layer **40b** may include a protective film layer (insulation mylar). For example, the protective film layer may be a polyimide film (polyimide film, PI).

(102) Optionally, only one protective film layer may cover the FPC body **40a**.

(103) Optionally, the functional film layer **40b** may further include a shielding film layer, and the shielding film layer may be a metal (for example, copper) layer.

(104) Optionally, the FPC body **40a** may be successively covered with a protective film layer, a shielding film layer, and a protective film layer.

(105) Optionally, the FPC body **40a** may include at least one conductive layer.

(106) For example, the FPC body **40a** may be a single-layer board, a dual-layer board, or a multi-layer board (for example, three, four, or five-layer). This is not limited in this application.

(107) FIG. **16** is a schematic diagram of a structure of another example of the first FPC **40** in FIG. **13**.

(108) As shown in FIG. **16**, compared with the foregoing embodiment shown in FIG. **15**, in this embodiment, the thinning region **43** is formed by performing thinning on the FPC body **40a**. In this case, the FPC body **40a** may be first thinned and then covered with the functional film layer **40b**.

(109) Optionally, a part or all of at least one conductive layer of the FPC body **40a** may be removed, and then the FPC body **40a** is covered with the functional film layer **40b**, to form the thinning region **43**.

(110) For example, the FPC body **40a** may be a multi-layer board. A part or all (for example, one layer) of the multi-layer board may be removed, and then the multi-layer board is covered with the functional film layer **40b**, to form the thinning region **43**.

(111) FIG. **17** is an exploded view of another example of the electronic device **100** from a perspective according to an embodiment of this application. FIG. **18** is an exploded view of another example of the electronic device **100** from another perspective according to an embodiment of this application.

(112) Compared with those of the foregoing electronic device **100** shown in FIG. **3** to FIG. **16**, in this embodiment, the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** are located on a same side of the middle frame **30**. To be specific, as shown in FIG. **17** and FIG. **18**, in this embodiment, both the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** are located between the middle frame **30** and the display **20**.

(113) Optionally, in another implementation, the first FPC **40** and the second FPC **50** may alternatively be located between the middle frame **30** and the battery **60**. This is not limited in this application.

(114) In this case, the second FPC **50** is located between the middle frame **30** and the first FPC **40**, and a bending part **52** may be disposed on the second FPC **50**. A rear side of the bending part **52** is concave to form accommodation space, and the accommodation space accommodates the first FPC **40**. A front side of the bending part **52** protrudes into the first through hole **31**, for example, may be extended/embedded into the first through hole **31**, to implement thinning.

(115) Correspondingly, the first groove **33** and the second groove **34** may be disposed on a same side of the middle frame **30**, the first FPC **40** is disposed in the first groove **33**, and the second FPC **50** is disposed in the second groove **34**. The first through hole **31** is disposed at an intersection of the first groove **33** and the second groove **34**.

(116) The foregoing descriptions are merely specific implementations of this application. However, the protection scope of this application is not limited thereto. Any change or replacement readily figured out by a person skilled in the art within the technical scope disclosed in this application shall fall within the protection scope of this application. Therefore, the protection scope of this application shall be subject to the protection scope of the claims.

Claims

1. An electronic device, comprising: a middle frame having a first through hole; a first flexible printed circuit (FPC); a second FPC; and a battery; wherein a first groove and a second groove are respectively disposed on two side surfaces of the middle frame, wherein the first FPC is disposed in the first groove, and the second FPC is disposed in the second groove, wherein projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a first overlapping region, wherein the first overlapping region is located inside a projection of the battery on the middle frame and is far away

from an edge of the battery, and wherein the first overlapping region is located in the first through hole.

2. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein an avoidance hole is disposed on the first FPC, and wherein the first FPC avoids the second FPC by the avoidance hole, so that the first overlapping region is far away from the edge of the battery.

3. The electronic device according to claim 2, wherein the first FPC and the second FPC are respectively disposed on two opposite sides of the middle frame.

4. The electronic device according to claim 3, wherein the middle frame comprises a protrusion part, wherein a front end of the protrusion part extends into the avoidance hole, and wherein a rear end of the protrusion part forms avoidance space accommodating the second FPC.

5. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a second overlapping region, wherein the first FPC further comprises a thinning region, wherein a thickness of the thinning region is less than a thickness of another region of the first FPC, and a projection of the thinning region on the middle frame covers the second overlapping region.

6. The electronic device according to claim 5, wherein the first overlapping region is connected to the second overlapping region.

7. The electronic device according to claim 5, wherein the first FPC comprises an FPC body and a functional film layer that are stacked, and wherein the FPC body and the functional film layer are thinned to form the thinning region.

8. The electronic device according to claim 7, wherein the functional film layer comprises a protective film layer and a shielding film layer.

9. The electronic device according to claim 5, wherein the first FPC comprises an FPC body and a functional film layer that are stacked, and wherein the FPC body is thinned to form the thinning region.

10. The electronic device according to claim 5, wherein the first FPC comprises an FPC body and a functional film layer that are stacked, and wherein the functional film layer is thinned to form the thinning region.

11. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the first FPC is a screen FPC of the electronic device, and the second FPC is a main FPC of the electronic device.

12. The electronic device according to claim 11, wherein the first FPC is fixedly attached to an inner surface of a display of the electronic device by a first back adhesive layer, and the second FPC is fixedly attached to the middle frame by a second back adhesive layer.

13. The electronic device according to claim 12, wherein a third groove is further disposed on the middle frame in the second groove, and wherein the second back adhesive layer is disposed in the third groove.

14. The electronic device according to claim 11, wherein the first FPC passes through a second through hole and is electrically connected to a main board of the electronic device, wherein the second through hole is disposed on the middle frame.

15. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the first FPC and the second FPC are located on two opposite sides of the middle frame.

16. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein contours of the first through hole and the first overlapping region overlap.

17. An electronic device, comprising: a main board; a middle frame having a first through hole and a second through hole; a first flexible printed circuit (FPC) passing through the second through hole and being electrically connected to a main board; a second FPC; and a battery; wherein a first groove and a second groove are respectively disposed on two side surfaces of the middle frame, wherein the first FPC is disposed in the first groove, and the second FPC is disposed in the second groove, wherein projections of the first FPC and the second FPC on the middle frame have a first overlapping region, wherein the first overlapping region is located inside a projection of the battery

on the middle frame and is far away from an edge of the battery, and wherein the first overlapping region is located in the first through hole.

18. The electronic device according to claim 17, wherein an avoidance hole is disposed on the first FPC, and wherein the first FPC avoids the second FPC by the avoidance hole, so that the first overlapping region is far away from the edge of the battery.

19. The electronic device according to claim 17, wherein the first FPC is a screen FPC of the electronic device, and the second FPC is a main FPC of the electronic device.
